

Philipp Hilbert. *Technical Product Owner for data-driven enterprise platforms.*

Positioning, Thirteen years of product ownership in regulated industries, with a proven record of taming complex backlogs, leading cross-functional data platform teams, and shipping analytically grounded outcomes at pace.

BERLIN, GERMANY · HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN · TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

§ WHY EMIRATES

Emirates Group's Analytics Centre of Excellence is one of the few corporate data organisations operating at a scale where the data platform itself is a strategic asset, not a support function. The role sits at the intersection of airline operations, customer analytics, and modern data architecture, which is exactly the cross-domain environment where a TPO earns their keep by translating business KPIs into coherent backlog priorities across multiple engineering teams. The ACoE's charter to make Emirates a genuinely data-driven organisation, rather than a reporting-heavy one, reflects the kind of structural ambition I find motivating. *That is exactly the kind of compounding challenge where rigorous product ownership makes a measurable difference.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, day-to-day coding assistance
- **Cursor / VSCode**, LLM-assisted development environment
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **GPT**, research, drafting, edge-case generation
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation

- **Dagster**, data pipeline orchestration
 - **dbt**, data build tool for ETL modelling
-

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps rollout and rollback, Jenkins, CI/CD, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, REST APIs, Dagster, dbt, ETL pipelines, MicroStrategy, Matomo, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B construction-staffing marketplace built solo from zero to one.

- Anonymity-until-payment model protecting both firms and workers until commitment is confirmed.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface, removing onboarding friction.
 - LLM agents across the funnel so one operator handles the full day-to-day without additional headcount.
 - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL, directly informing backlog prioritisation, the same discipline the ACoE role demands.
-

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT EMIRATES

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Sit with ACoE engineers and business counterparts to map the current state of backlog health, PI planning cadence, and data product documentation, identifying where acceptance criteria are missing or where technical debt has been deferred without a capture mechanism.

WEEK 2

Triage and align.

Slice the backlog into feature, NFR, technical debt, and spike buckets with the team; surface the top cross-backlog dependencies and risk items ahead of the next PI Planning cycle.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close loops.

Drive story sign-off discipline, establish KPI definitions for the first prioritised data products, and begin contributing to the TPO community of practice, building the collaborative identity the posting explicitly calls for.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Technical Product Owner, Data Science & AI Platform role at Emirates Group. With thirteen years of product ownership across public-sector analytics, defence AI platforms, insurance SaaS, healthcare, and fintech, I have spent the bulk of my career doing exactly what this role describes: owning the full backlog lifecycle across feature, NFR, technical debt, BAU, and spike work, and being the single accountable voice that connects engineering teams to business outcomes.

The role that maps most directly onto what the ACoE is building is my time at the Federal Employment Agency (Bundesagentur für Arbeit), where I owned the national labour-market analytics platform. There I introduced Dagster and dbt to replace manual quarterly imports with automated, auditable data pipelines, cutting time per data update by almost 75%, while simultaneously carrying a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration. I defined KPIs with policymakers and researchers, maintained data dictionaries and business metadata for each indicator, and acted as Deputy IT Security Officer. That combination of modern data architecture, stakeholder-facing KPI ownership, and operational discipline in a regulated environment mirrors the ACoE's mandate closely.

At Rohde & Schwarz I managed the internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme, a multinational delivery programme with 15+ engineers and data scientists. I championed GitOps delivery with ArgoCD that reduced rollout time from days to 30 minutes, and I redirected the product strategy based on instrumented workflow analysis, pipeline runs increased 200% after we deprioritised a UI-led design that recorded exactly zero real clicks in production. That kind of evidence-based reprioritisation is what I mean by outcome over output, and it is the discipline the ACoE needs at the backlog level.

I am comfortable in Scaled Agile environments with large team counts. At Scheidt & Bachmann I worked within a full SAFe setup across agile release trains and PI planning. I understand the PI Planning rhythm, the role of the TPO as the team-facing product voice, and the discipline required to keep backlogs prepared on time and refined continuously. Emirates is operating at a scale where that SAFe fluency is not optional, and I bring it without a learning curve.

On the aviation and airline domain specifically: I do not carry prior airline-industry employment, but I bring a Master's degree in Industrial Engineering with a logistics specialisation from TU Berlin, and a career pattern of rapidly internalising new technical domains, public sector labour markets, defence aerospace, health insurance, and becoming a credible internal expert within the first quarter. I am also actively targeting a move to Dubai and would arrive already committed to the location rather than treating relocation as a risk.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background maps onto the ACoE's current data product roadmap.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Owner and Product Manager with 13 years of ownership in regulated, data-intensive environments, public-sector analytics, defence AI platforms, insurance SaaS, healthcare, and fintech. At the Federal Employment Agency I owned a national analytics platform end-to-end: ETL pipelines, KPI definition, data dictionaries, and business metadata across stakeholder communities. At Rohde & Schwarz I led a cross-functional team of 15+ through Scrum on an internal AI and data platform for a multinational programme, driving a 200% increase in pipeline runs through evidence-based reprioritisation. Strong in SAFe, PI Planning, and multi-team backlog discipline.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Analytics and Data: KPI (key performance indicator) definition, data dictionaries, business metadata management, ETL (extract, transform, load), Dagster, dbt (data build tool), MicroStrategy, Matomo, PostgreSQL, funnel and churn analysis

Product Ownership: acceptance criteria definition, user stories, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT (user acceptance testing), Jira, Confluence

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAgile (Scaled Agile Framework), ART (agile release train), PI planning, WIP limits

Product Management: continuous discovery, product roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, A/B testing, user research and interviews, product lifecycle management

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, Explainable AI (XAI), EU AI Act, AI governance; prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable

Stakeholder and Leadership: cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, change management, Deputy IT Security Officer

e-Commerce and Governance: Shopware webshop delivery, GDPR, identity management, budget ownership

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI PLATFORM 2024-2025

Led AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme; 15+ engineers and data scientists in Scrum. GitOps rollout with ArgoCD cut release time from days to 30 minutes; workflow instrumentation drove a 200% increase in pipeline runs.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

Owned national labour-market analytics platform: introduced Dagster and dbt, cutting data-update time by 75%; carried full ETL migration and UI relaunch; Deputy IT Security Officer. Jira, Confluence, Jenkins, PostgreSQL.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE 2023-2023

Cut a five-person team's roadmap to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures; user acceptance rose fivefold. Delivered CGM/KIS interface reducing digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE SAAS 2022-2022

Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; attrition fell from near-total exodus to one departure. Shipped Claims Center concept-to-production; cut time-to-market for new insurance products from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · RETAIL AND PAYMENTS 2021-2022

Moved research results into production in a full SAFe environment with agile release trains and PI planning. POS and forecourt systems, matrix organisation.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT 2021-2021

Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH; secure government data platform.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE 2019-2020

Migrated legacy B2B procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; still in production. Backlog refinement, user stories, acceptance criteria in Jira.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY 2019-2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING 2025-2026

Zero-to-one B2B marketplace; LLM agents across the funnel; SQL-based funnel and conversion analysis; anonymity-until-payment model.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · IT SECURITY 2016-2021

Quantum-secure encryption hardware/software; three-layer product installing in under two minutes for enterprise buyers. Later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO · AGRI-TECH 2018-2021

Lab-to-investor-round for a nanotechnology fertiliser product; financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH 2013-2018

Mobile P2P group payments; built from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · EMIRATES

